

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 939

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION commending Taiwan for its deepening relations with the United States and the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, the United States of America and Taiwan are long-standing partners that share and cherish the values of democracy, peace, and prosperity, and the State of Tennessee commends Taiwan for pursuing "Integrated Diplomacy" and advancing its "Three Chains" Strategy, grounded in shared values, strong partnerships, and economic vitality, which, through the strategic frameworks of the Global Democratic Value Chain, the First Island Chain in the Indo-Pacific, and the Non-Red Supply Chain, strengthen ties with like-minded nations, safeguard regional security, and leverage Taiwan's technological and economic achievements to promote mutually beneficial partnerships in the Indo-Pacific region; and

WHEREAS, the year 2026 marks both the 250th anniversary of the independence of the United States and the thirtieth anniversary of Taiwan's first direct presidential election—milestones that honor liberty and the principle that sovereignty resides in the people; and

WHEREAS, this shared celebration reaffirms Taiwan-U.S. commitment to the rule of law, human rights, and a rules-based international order; through close cooperation, Taiwan and the United States strengthen democratic values and contribute to Indo-Pacific security, economic resilience, and global peace and stability for future generations; and

WHEREAS, the People's Republic of China has repeatedly engaged in economic coercion, conducted military exercises directed toward Taiwan, and misinterpreted United Nations General Assembly Resolution 2758 (XXVI) to obstruct Taiwan's contributions to the international community, thereby contributing to global challenges to the rules-based international order, enabling aggressive authoritarian expansionism, and undermining the progress of free and open societies; and

WHEREAS, Taiwan is the United States' seventh-largest trading partner, and the United States is Taiwan's second-largest, with bilateral trade-in-goods value estimated at \$158.8 billion in 2024; Taiwan ranked as Tennessee's sixth-largest market and eighteenth-largest export market in the world in 2024; and

WHEREAS, the first Agreement implemented under the U.S.-Taiwan Initiative on 21st Century Trade entered into force on December 10, 2024, strengthening the institutional foundation for deepening the United States-Taiwan economic and trade partnership; and

WHEREAS, building on this framework, the State of Tennessee and Taiwan intend to work closely to expand mutually beneficial trade, investment, and commercial cooperation, and to identify and pursue new economic opportunities; and

WHEREAS, in October 2025, Governor Bill Lee led a trade delegation to Taiwan, signed an Economic Memorandum of Understanding, and announced plans to establish a Tennessee presence in Taiwan in 2026, thereby promoting two-way trade, investment, and industrial cooperation through information sharing, business visits, local support, connections to appropriate contacts and available incentives, briefings, and collaboration in R&D and technology applications; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee and Taiwan are entering into negotiations on Memoranda of Understanding concerning K-12 education, higher education, and high-tech talent education, intending to cultivate professionals with a global vision and strengthen scientific, educational, economic, social, cultural, and other learning-related programs and linkages between the Volunteer State and Taiwan in the field of educational cooperation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commend Taiwan for its deepening relations with the United States and

the State of Tennessee, extending our most sincere best wishes for continued cooperation and success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.